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PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

SECOND MEETING, 2025

Monday, 7th July, 2025

The House met at 3.22 p.m.

[MR FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER IN
THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we would proceed to take the item numbered 7— *Correction of Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, *Correction of Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 3rd July, 2025, to be corrected.

Page 1...8—

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, on page 8, under the subheading “Recognition of Dignitaries”, the item numbered 7 (viii) “Members the Indian Community in Ghana”. I would suggest that we insert “of” after “Members”. So that it would read “Members of the Indian Community in Ghana”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are right. Table Office, kindly take note.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, under the same item numbered 7 (viii) on page 8, under the subheading “Recognition of Dignitaries” My understanding of the word “dignitaries” has to do with important individuals. So, the item numbered 7 (v) which reads “Representatives of the Ga Mantse”; the next one on the item numbered 7 (vi) “Independent Constitutional Bodies” and on the item numbered 7 (vii) “Civil Society Organisations”. I would suggest that we put the word “Representatives” before the item numbered 7 (vi) and (vii). So that it would read “Representatives of Independent Constitutional Bodies” as well as “Representatives of Civil Society Organisation”.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office, Kindly take note.

Page 9...12 —

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, on page 12, the item numbered 16, line 3, insert “i” after “n” in “Minster”. The Clerks-at-the-Table could kindly take note and correct accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are right. Table Office, kindly take note.

Page 13...16—

Hon Members, in the absence of any further corrections, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 3rd July, 2025, is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, I have with me the *Official Report* of Wednesday, 25th June, 2025. Any corrections? *[Pause]*

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Wednesday, 25th June, 2025.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leader, any indication?

Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I rely on Order 92 of the Rules of this House to proceed to say that this morning, we were informed that one of us has been summoned to the Parliament above.

3.41 p.m.

It is quite regrettable for me to be the carrier of this message to this august House. Mr Speaker, the Member was seen over the weekend, hale and hearty. He was able to undertake his Committee work, and prior to that, we all saw him at the Plenary. Mr Speaker, this Member was a young politician from the Eastern Region and this was his first term in this Chamber. He was one who carried with him a lot of promise to contribute to the discourse of this democratic enterprise.

Mr Speaker, it took his resilience to come to this august Assembly of the people's representatives. He was determined to serve his people for the

term he was elected to serve. Mr Speaker, the Caucus of the New Patriotic Party (NPP); the Minority Caucus has been struck by this sudden summons to our Brother to the Parliament above; I am referring to our Brother, Ernest Kumi of Akwatia.

Mr Speaker, we are in touch with the family and as it is customary, at the appropriate time, Parliament and its Leadership shall be informed. This information under Order 92 must not be seen and construed in terms of any constitutional imperative; it is very informal. And just to say that for the avoidance of doubt, the necessary requirements that may trigger any further process is properly outlined in the Constitution.

Mr Speaker, we are aware that our respected Brother who has been summoned by the Lord who presides over the Parliament above, left a family; a wife and children. I am, through this medium, expressing on behalf of the Caucus, our condolences to the bereaved family. And to the people of Akwatia who found him worthy of their trust and therefore elected him to represent them, the Caucus says to them, *koɛ*. We know that this is sudden and unexpected. The Member was not seen as somebody who was unwell and therefore, we are pained. But like we say, God knows best.

Mr Speaker, I just checked the background of this young man. He was born in 1984. He pursued his first degree and per his public records, he has pursued three second degrees; an MBA in Corporate Governance, an LLB and an

MSc in Defence and International Politics. Prior to joining this Chamber, he served as a security manager.

Mr Speaker, a lot can be said. For now, I would want to leave it here by way of the credentials he brought to this House. Mr Speaker, his records in this House, both at the Plenary and Committee levels, are quite profound and are known to all. Above all, this Brother had all that anybody would want to have in a brother. He lived the prayer of this House, “a country of righteousness where none shall wrong his neighbour”. No one can ever say that in his few months in this Chamber, he was controversial or wronged Colleagues. He was always here; we saw him happy every day.

Mr Speaker, this House is aware that we have programmed a couple of Businesses for today. The Majority Leader informed us last week of Business for this week. It is the prayer of this Side of the House, the NPP Minority Caucus of 88, regrettably minus one, that with indulgence of the Leader of the House, today’s proceedings be terminated as we observe a minute of silence in his honour. Mr Speaker, it is a very sad day; a sad day to a family, to a constituency, to democracy, to Parliament and to the people of Ghana. We know not when any of us may receive a summons. Colleagues, let us take heart and continue with our service to mother Ghana.

Mr Speaker, I appreciate this treasured space to break this unfortunate news. I do so with a lot of regrets and a lot of

hesitation, but it is my duty to be the bearer of this, and I have done so.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

3.41 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, definitely and arguably, this is one of the saddest days for this House.

Like he said, I saw on the platform some publication to the effect that we had lost our younger Brother, Hon Ernest Kumi, but I did not believe it. We know, in our politics, sometimes, people put out all sort of things, so I just thought it was —Then I got another message that said:

“Leader, it is serious; it is true. It has been published by *Joy News* and other credible news platforms.”

I was really saddened by the development. He was very young; he is just a little over 40 years, and he was very bright, as the Minority Leader has presented vividly. Within a short period, he had strung a number of degrees in diverse fields of study, showing that this is a very studious young man.

At that age, he believed in democracy, participated effectively and as a result, took a constituency as weighty as Akwatia from within his party and in the general elections. So, this is a young man full of promise for the store of knowledge, intellect and energy that this

House needs to sustain. This is the prime of his life. Like the Hon Minority Leader has indicated, he had everything that a young man of his age would need. To be taken away from us at this stage in his life is not only a loss to his family and Akwatia as a constituency, it is a loss to Ghana because we would not know where he would have ended up in terms of the leadership of this country and we may never know what we have missed by losing him so early in his political career.

I believe that this House has suffered a terrible blow and it is a kind of blow that, when one takes, he or she cannot stand and even sitting would be a problem. So, I join my Hon Colleague to appeal to Hon Colleagues here and then Mr Speaker that we take an adjournment for today; then tomorrow, we can come back and put ourselves together to be able to conduct public business.

I know this is not a time for reading tributes. The family and his constituency are still struggling to come to terms with what has happened. But we extend our condolences to them and our prayers are with them. As a House, we are with them in this period of extreme grief that they

must be suffering now. It is not the Minority Caucus that has lost; it is this Parliament that has lost because he was a Member of the House before he was a Member of the Minority Caucus.

So, Mr Speaker, I join my Hon Colleague to pray for an adjournment, so that we can all go back and put ourselves together.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, may we observe a minute's silence.

[A minute's silence was observed]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: May his soul rest in perfect peace. Amen.

Hon Members, I will, therefore, put the Question for adjournment.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 3.47 p.m. till Tuesday, 8th July, 2025, at 2.00 p.m.

Editor's Note

This Official Report was corrected by the House on 10th July, 2025 as follows:

- (a) Column 3, paragraph 5, line 2,
“the was deleted before “Order 92”
- (b) Column 4, paragraph 4, line 2,
“was” was inserted after “He”.